# City and County Profile

East Detroit, Colorado | 2030 population and services

City and County of East Detroit

November 2030

## City overview

The City and County of East Detroit covers about **115.4 square miles** east of Denver International Airport. Its population is **382,417**. The municipality includes the historic Watkins area, new residential communities, downtown employment and cultural districts, agricultural land, and the Colorado Air and Space Port corridor. Fast growth has placed new neighborhoods alongside older roads, parcels, water systems and local institutions.

East Detroit is a consolidated city-county. One local government handles municipal functions and county responsibilities. Independent school, library, water, transit, court, hospital and housing agencies continue to serve the same area under separate governing arrangements.

### Population and housing

| Measure | 2030 |
|---|---|
| Residents | 382,417 |
| Occupied households | 155,800 |
| Residents in group quarters | 3,823 |
| Renters, share of households | 53.6% |
| Median household income (2024 dollars) | $88,430 |
| Median gross rent (2024 dollars) | $1,865 |
| People below the poverty line | 12.8% |
| Renter households spending at least 30% of income on housing | 49.8% |

| Measure | 2030 |
|---|---|
| Residents under 18 | 22.6% |
| Residents 65 or older | 11.6% |
| Residents born outside the United States | 18.4% |
| Residents speaking another language at home | 29.6% |
| Residents without health insurance | 10.6% |

Housing costs vary substantially. High Prairie has a median household income of $151,200, while Colfax East has a median of $58,900. The city has twenty neighborhoods grouped into five planning regions. The neighborhood and community profile provides the complete neighborhood table and descriptions.

## Geography and growth

Watkins, Interstate 70, Colfax Avenue, Box Elder Creek and the Union Pacific corridor are established geographic anchors. The Colorado Air and Space Port occupies a major aviation and employment site. East Detroit’s expansion extends north and east of the spaceport planning area.

The Adams County Colorado Air and Space Port Subarea Plan provides a useful account of this landscape before East Detroit’s expansion. Its 48-square-mile study area included unincorporated county land and territory within Aurora and Bennett. It identifies water and wastewater capacity, freight movement, and airport-compatible land use as central development issues. Those conditions continue to shape service demands.

The developed city covers about 25 square miles. Other land supports aviation operations, agriculture, employment, infrastructure and open space. The municipality includes both dense neighborhoods and areas where travel distances and service connections remain difficult.

## Services and institutions

The municipal government runs human services, planning and building review, local housing programs, the address register, finance, digital services, emergency response, public health, parks, transportation and other county-city functions.

Independent organizations include the **East Detroit Regional Housing Authority**, **East Detroit Unified School District**, **East Detroit Public Library District**, **East Detroit Water and Sewer Authority**, **East Detroit County Court**, **East Detroit Health and Hospital Authority**, and **Regional Transportation District (RTD)**. The East Detroit Health System operates a separate Level I trauma and teaching hospital.

The **City Housing Division** finances local housing programs, development and preservation; the regional housing authority administers its own housing portfolio and assistance programs throughout East Detroit and participating neighboring communities. They serve overlapping households and report to different governing bodies.

## Civic and cultural institutions

- **The Hangar at Space Center:** 17,500-seat arena at Central Station, home of the Denver Fawns (WNBA) and Colorado Apex (PWHL).
- **Aerotropolis Park:** 16,210-seat ballpark for the Denver Pilots, a Triple-A baseball franchise relocated from Albuquerque.
- **East Detroit Philharmonic and Performing Arts Center:** 2,200-seat performance hall.
- **East Detroit Health System:** Level I regional trauma center, flight medicine and teaching hospital.

## Regional sources

- Adams County: Colorado Air and Space Port Subarea Plan — airport-adjacent land, land use and utility limits.
- U.S. Census Bureau: Adams County QuickFacts — regional income, housing and population measures.

- 2020–2024 American Community Survey: Watkins — the original Watkins community.
- Colorado Legislative Council: Local Government Handbook (2023) — city, county and district responsibilities.